

Grade 4 - Vermont, the Early Republic and the U.S.: Pre-Colonial Times through the Civil War

Overview

In grade 4, students will examine change and continuity in Vermont and United States history from pre-colonial times through the Civil War. Students will understand the concept of movement and its impact on people, goods, and ideas; learn how natural resources have influenced economic development; and examine the conflicts and compromises that resulted from migration and settlement. This learning will allow students to understand the tensions and factors that led to the fight for independence, the establishment of the United States, and subsequent Vermont statehood. Students will prepare for their role as responsible and informed citizens by examining the Vermont Constitution and the United States Constitution, including the determinants of power and its effects; exploring the development, structure, and function of the United States government as well as the role of individual rights and responsibilities; examining the choices made by various groups of people on the development of the United States through the Civil War; and learn how events, people, and ideas shaped and influenced our democratic system. Grade 4 provides the framework for further study of Vermont and United States History in Grade 7, civics in Grade 8, and United States History/American Government in high school.

Looking Back

In grade 3, students expanded on their understanding of the concept of community and widened their global lens by exploring Africa, Asia, Europe, and Oceania. Students learned about continuities and differences among cultures, governments, traditions, and resources. Students learned about the idea of culture spreading across borders and were able to see the ways various cultural groups connect and interact.

Looking Ahead

In grade 5, students will examine how people moved, traded, and interacted with others in early civilizations. They will learn how geography, power, wealth, and religion shaped the growth and culture of these societies. Students



will focus on regions like Western Asia, the Middle East, North Africa, and Sub-Saharan Africa. They will also learn about important cultural contributions and lasting achievements in technology.

Inquiry

Why inquiry? Using inquiry as an instructional model for the teaching of social studies allows students to authentically ask questions, search for and analyze evidence, and provide explanations and arguments to challenges facing their world.

The inquiry instructional model is driven by authentic questions or problems that have relevance for children. Students learn content, skills, and dispositions as they seek answers to questions and as they apply their learning to take informed action. Pioneered by Dewey (1938), inquiry is an attempt to make classroom experiences feel more like the authentic, curiosity-driven experiences that motivate learning outside of school. ([Using Inquiry to Prepare Students for College, Career, and Civic Life](#), elementary edition, p. 22)

The Inquiry Arc is defined in Dimension 1 (questions), Dimension 3 (evidence), and Dimension 4 (communication) of the [College, Career, and Civic Life \(C3\) Framework for Social Studies State Standards](#). In the AOE-developed Proficiency-Based Learning Social Studies Hierarchy, Dimensions 1, 2, and 3, as well as evidence indicators found within Dimension 2 – History, have been combined into a singular Critical Proficiency – the Inquiry Process. Opportunities for showing proficiency in the Inquiry Process fall within the K-2, 3-5, 6-8 grade bands of the Priority Performance Indicators (below): Constructing Compelling and Supporting Questions, Gathering and Evaluating Sources, and Communicating and Critiquing Solutions. The Inquiry Process Critical Proficiency, as with all of the CPs, begins its focus in the elementary grades and spans through high school, preparing students to attain proficiency in social studies for college and career readiness.

The Critical Proficiency (CP) remains the same K-12 and identifies the enduring skills and knowledge that all students need to demonstrate (across contexts) to be prepared for future learning, including post-secondary career and college readiness. Priority Performance Indicators clarify what will be taught and assessed at each grade cluster.

Critical Proficiency (K-12): Students act as social scientists as they ask questions, think critically, solve problems, and share conclusions.

Priority Performance Indicators: (3-5)

Constructing Compelling and Supporting Questions: Explain why compelling and supporting questions are important and how associated ideas can be open to different interpretations. (D1. 1-3)

Gathering and Evaluating Sources: Compare information from different sources and use differences between fact and opinion to determine the credibility of the source. (D2. His. 10, 12; D3. 1-3)

Communicating and Critiquing Solutions: Use evidence from multiple sources to develop a claim or argument about the past. (D2. His. 16; D4. 1)

Overarching Grade 4 Themes:

- Foundations
- Evolving Economies
- Defining Boundaries
- Division

Civics

Critical Proficiency (K-12): Students act as productive citizens by understanding the historical foundations, and principles of our democracy through multiple lenses, and by acquiring the ability to become engaged in civic and democratic processes.

Theme: Foundations

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Civic and Political Institutions Explain the origins, function, key provisions and structure of the United States and Vermont Constitution, including the roles and responsibilities of citizens, organizations, and governments within a democratic system. (D2. Civ. 1-6)	Students will be able to identify the structures, functions, and powers granted by the Vermont and United States constitutions. Students will be able to identify ways the constitution(s) has changed to meet the needs and wants of society over time.	Vermont Constitution and United States Constitution: frameworks/branches, structures, powers (executive, legislative, judicial), similarities and differences, amendment process, Bill of Rights • Democracy • Republic • Common Good

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Civic Virtues and Democratic Principles Identify and apply core civic virtues and democratic principles that guide personal beliefs, as well as those of government, societies, and communities. (D2. Civ. 7, 8, 9, 10)	Students will be able to describe how participating in a democratic system can take on different forms in the United States over time (e.g., from pre-colonial times through the Civil War).	• Governing Bodies – Native American Councils, New England Town Meetings, Virginia House of Burgesses, Continental Congress • Documents – Mayflower Compact, Declaration of Independence, Articles of Confederation, United States Constitution, State Constitutions • Participation – Suffrage, Dissent, Movements, Rebellion
Rules, Processes, and Laws Identify and apply core civic virtues and democratic principles that guide personal beliefs, as well as those of government, societies, and communities. (D2. Civ. 7, 8, 9, 10)	Students will be able to explain how the United States Constitution sets the foundation for national laws, and how local and national governments work together.	• Local, state, national laws • Federal system • State system • County, towns, municipalities, etc.

Resources

[A Lesson Plan for Independence Day, the Fourth of July](#) - Center for Civic Education: In this lesson, students will examine some of the fundamental ideas about government that are contained in the Declaration of Independence and the Preamble to the United States Constitution. Students should be able to explain those ideas and identify which ideas the class holds in common.

[Assessing Access](#) - Learning for Justice: Students will apply the principles of American democracy to people with disabilities by analyzing how individuals and groups in American society have struggled to achieve the liberties and equality promised in the principles of American democracy.

[Becoming a State](#) - Vermont History Explorer: This three-day lesson introduces the students to the conflicts between the Yorkers and the New Hampshire Grants by asking the students to pretend they are settlers or investors who receive charters and patents for new towns in Vermont. The students divide the towns and investigate the natural resources on their land. After writing their own constitution, the students learn about Vermont's Constitution and see the official document that made Vermont the 14th state.

[BRI, JR](#) - Bill of Rights Institute: Character, History, and Civics for Younger Learners: Ten lessons that are primary source based, inquiry-based, content-area literacy instruction focused, modular, and time-friendly. Each lesson contains: paper-based worksheets, a tie to their [BRI Jr. Principles & Virtues Framework](#), performance-based assessments, Lexiled readings, games and/or simulations, and an optional video component.

[Constitution Lessons](#): Select by grade level. The Center for Civic Education has developed constitution-focused lesson plans with topics such as “What Basic Ideas About Government are Included in the Preamble to the Constitution?” and “What Should the Representative Do?”

[Declaration of Independence](#) - C3 IDM (5th grade inquiry that may need support): This inquiry asks why countries declare their independence. As an integral early step in the process of becoming independent, a declaration of independence functions as an argument for why people should be free. This inquiry focuses on the argument made in the United States Declaration of Independence. With a firm understanding of the American colonists' argument for

independence, the inquiry shifts to students conducting research on declarations of independence in other parts of the Western Hemisphere.

Elementary Curriculum: Colonial America to Reconstruction - The Gilder Lehrman Institute for American History:

This curated suite of resources for elementary school educators will help expand your knowledge of important topic areas in the elementary curriculum through a selection of six curated topics, such as Colonial America and the United States Constitution. You will find lesson plans, student activity sheets, videos for students, interactive maps and timelines, recorded lectures, and free professional development courses.

Government and Citizens - C3 IDM: This inquiry is an exploration into government that begins by looking at the historical roots of democracy in the United States and then focuses on state government. The inquiry features a case study of a piece of legislation, initiated by a class of New York State elementary school students that resulted in yogurt becoming the official state snack of New York. In examining the idea that we have a voice in our government, especially through state representation, students develop an argument supported by evidence that answers the compelling question, ‘Why does New York have a state snack?’”

How Did Opposition to Laws Fuel the American Revolutionary War? - iCivics Education: What happens when people don’t have a say in the laws? In this inquiry-based unit, students will explore how the American colonies’ resistance to laws fueled the American Revolutionary War. They will analyze different points of view about the Stamp Act, investigate colonial reactions to the Intolerable Acts, and determine when exactly the American Revolutionary War began.

Life, Liberty, and the Pursuit of Happiness. National Archives: Students will learn about the Declaration of Independence, its important sections, and some of the American ideals it contains. Students will explore primary sources about the American Revolution and the Founders and investigate copies of the Declaration of Independence from the National Archives. This Civics for All of U.S. distance learning program is available for groups of 10 or more students free of charge. Each program will be led by one of the educators located at National Archives sites, the Center for Legislative Archives, and Presidential Libraries across the country. After submitting a program request, the educator will be connected to an available National Archives educator to confirm the reservation. It is required that the requesting educator or another educator from the institution be present during the student distance learning program to observe the session and support classroom management. Programs are also offered as [regularly scheduled interactive webinars](#). Registration is required, but there is no minimum attendance prerequisite. Questions? Please contact civics@nara.gov.

[Vermont Classroom Blueprint](#) - **Vermont Office of the Secretary of State:** A K-12 “blueprint” providing resources and lesson plans for active civic engagement in your classroom.

Economics

Critical Proficiency (K-12): Students make sound economic decisions through understanding the interactions between humans, governments, economic systems and both the national and global marketplaces.

Theme: Evolving Economies

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Economic Decision Making Identify the incentives (positive/ negative) that influence economic decisions and the benefits and costs of such decisions. (D2. Econ. 1, 2)	Students will be able to explain how natural resources have influenced economic development in the United States over time (e.g., from pre-colonial times through the Civil War).	Natural Resources and Economic Growth • Timber in New England colonies • Fur trading • Farming and agriculture - subsistence farming, trade, slavery • Cotton in Antebellum South • Coal and iron ore • Gold Rush • Whaling

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Exchange and Markets Explain the role of business in an economic system, including resources that are needed for production, the purpose of specialization, mediums of exchange, and the value of investments. (D2. Econ. 3, 4, 5, 6, 9)	Students will be able to explain how trade impacted people and goods, in the United States over time (e.g., from pre-colonial times through the Civil War)	Impacts of Trade • Indigenous trade networks - cultural exchange, created alliances • European Mercantilism- growth of port cities, urbanization, reliance on exports • Triangular trade - Middle Passage; increase in demand for slave labor • Technology - Cotton gin; industrialization; railroads; Erie Canal and Trade expansion • Spread of disease • Indian Removal Act - value of land for farming • Manifest Destiny - displacement of indigenous tribes and Mexican landowners, minerals, land for farming

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
The National Economy Explain how the economy fluctuates and how the government can affect changes through interest rates and purchase of goods and services. (D2. Econ. 10, 11, 12, 13)	Students will be able to identify economic policy decisions that have been made in the United State over time (e.g., from pre-colonial United S through the Civil War). Students will be able to explain the ways that the government pays for the services and goods it provides (e.g., taxation).	Policy Decisions • Trade and barter • Mercantilism • Colonial paper money • Continental Congress Finances • First Bank of the United States 1791-1811 • Second Bank of the United States 1816-1836 • Hard Money vs Soft money Debate • Civil War Financing • National Banking Act • Purpose of taxes- Amendment 16
The Global Economy Explain how trade leads to economic interdependence and how trade can affect some groups of people. (D2. Econ. 15)	Students will be able to explain how trade impacted people and goods, in the United States over time (e.g., from pre-colonial United States through the Civil War).	International Trade • European Mercantilism and colonial trade • Triangular trade • Cotton trade and the Southern economy • Slavery/Middle Passage • Clipper ships and global trade • Blockades during the Civil War

Resources

[From Slavery to Freedom in Colonial Times](#) - **PBS Learning Media:** Learn the story of Venture Smith, an African boy who was enslaved and brought to America in 1737. In this interactive lesson, students will explore the differences between slavery in the North and South as they learn about Smith's journey from slavery to freedom.

[General Store Activity](#) - **Vermont History Explorer:** This activity was developed for the Vermont History Museum's *History for Homeschoolers* class focused on agriculture, and in connection with the General Store within the *Freedom & Unity* exhibit. During this activity, students act as if they are Vermont farmers in the 1830s. They will barter their goods for others with the same value within their community.

[Manhattan Purchase](#) - **C3 IDM:** On the surface, the compelling question for this inquiry, "What's the real story behind the purchase of Manhattan?" that asks students to explore the background to the story of the sale of Manhattan to the Dutch in 1626 for \$24 of beads and trinkets. A closer look at the story reveals a range of myths and unknowns including who was involved in the transaction, what the transaction actually meant, and what was exchanged.

[Seaclass](#) - **Mystic Seaport Museum:** This digital learning opportunity can support educator learning about the whaling industry with content including, "Why Whaling? The Impact and Industry Explained" and "Women in Whaling: Hidden Histories of the Sea."

[Teaching the Erie Canal](#) - **Erie Canalway National Heritage Corridor:** Interdisciplinary lessons (math, reading, PE, social studies, art, music, science) including mapping, "Cooking on the Erie Canal," and making a canal boat.

[The Beaver Trade and the Purchase of Manhattan](#) - **PBS Learning Media:** Learn about the extensive fur trade between the Dutch and Native Americans that sustained the early settlements of New Netherland in this video from *Dutch New York*; Teaching Tips and Discussion Questions included.

[The Panic of 1837](#) - **C3 IDM:** Students investigate the compelling question, "How Did Cotton Sow the Seeds of Panic?" Students identify the market forces of demand and supply during the boom and bust of the cotton industry in the United States during the time surrounding the Panic of 1837. They learn how economic and political forces impacted the treatment of enslaved persons in the United States during the lead up to The Panic of 1837. The depth of this inquiry is in the reflection on what role reliance on enslaved people as labor played in the economic growth of the United States. This emphasizes that individual and institutional choices can lead to the exploitation of individuals and groups.

Geography

Critical Proficiency (K-12): Students use geographic inquiry and reasoning to propose solutions to local, national, and global issues.

Theme: Defining Boundaries

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Geographic Representations: Spatial Views of the World Create and/or use maps with different scales of familiar and unfamiliar places, to explain relationships of places to their environment including cultural and environmental characteristics. (D2. Geo. 1, 2, 3)	Students will be able to use maps to explain significant patterns of movement within, and into, the United States over time (e.g., from pre-colonial United States through the Civil War).	Mapping Movement and Patterns • Triangle trade • Revolutionary War battles • Civil War battles • Westward expansion • Underground railroad • Political maps • Tribal lands

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Human-Environment Interaction: Place, Regions, and Culture Explain the relationship between culture and environment and how both can change over time. (D2. Geo. 4, 5, 6)	Students will be able to explain how shifts in population (e.g., slaves, Native Americans, etc.) within United States over time have impacted persons, the environment, and the cultural characteristics of the country.	Shifting Populations • Native American tribes and settlement patterns • Colonial settlements • Impact of slavery • Westward expansion • Manifest Destiny • Social movements • Native American removal • Civil War allegiances

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Human Population: Spatial Patterns and Movements Explain how population shifts affect both culture and environment, and how a changing environment can affect human settlement patterns. (D2. Geo. 7, 8, 9)	Students will be able to identify how movement impacted people, goods, and ideas in the United States from pre-colonial times through the Civil War. Students will be able to explain conflicts and compromises that occurred during migration and settlement in the United States (e.g., from pre-colonial times through the Civil War).	Technological Change, Westward Expansion, and Legislation • Technology – Cotton gin; increase in demand for slave labor • Westward expansion and pioneers • Northwest ordinance • Missouri Compromise • Compromise of 1850 Migration and Settlement Conflicts and Compromises • Native American resistance to European settlement – Powatan Wars, Pequot War; William Penn's Treaty with the Lenape • Colonial Expansion – Bacon's Rebellion; Proclamation of 1763 • Westward Expansion – Northwest Indian War; Land Ordinance of 1785, Northwest Ordinance of 1787 • 19th Century and Indian Removal – Seminole Wars; Indian Removal Act (also controversy/conflict) • Sectional Conflicts • Texas Annexation and Mexican American War • Missouri Compromise • Compromise of 1850 • Bleeding Kansas

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Global Interconnections: Changing Spatial Patterns Describe how spatial patterns can be transformed through natural and man-made disturbances, and how patterns vary across the world and can change over time. (D2. Geo. 10, 11, 12)	Students will be able to describe how natural resources have been impacted by movement patterns in the United States over time (e.g., from pre-colonial times through the Civil War).	Movement and Resources • Pre-colonial: Indigenous groups moved seasonally and traded regionally; sustainable use of land and wildlife; preservation of ecosystems • Colonial: settlers moved from inland from coastal areas; deforestation, land clearing, over hunting, introduction of non-native plants • Westward Expansion: westward move for land and opportunity; soil depletion and transformation of prairies to farmland • Cotton Boom: Enslaved labor in plantation South; soil depletion and land clearing for plantations • Gold Rush: migrants to western territories; mining disrupted rivers, damaged land, polluted water • Industrialization: expansion of transportation and trade; increased demand for fossil fuels; pollution; altered landscape to build railroad track and urban areas Conflicts and Compromises • Native American resistance to European settlement - Powatan Wars, Pequot War; William Penn's Treaty with the Lenape • Colonial Expansion – Bacon's Rebellion; Proclamation of 1763 • Westward Expansion – Northwest Indian War; Land Ordinance of 1785, Northwest Ordinance of 1787 • 19th Century and Indian Removal – Seminole Wars; Indian Removal Act (also controversy/conflict) • Sectional Conflicts

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Global Interconnections: Changing Spatial Patterns (continued)	(Continued)	• Texas Annexation and Mexican American War • Missouri Compromise • Compromise of 1850 • Bleeding Kansas

Resources

[Chief Joseph of the Nez Perce Speaks for the Indians](#) - **PBS Learning Media:** Students review and answer questions about a Nez Perce chief's various speeches he gave in the mid 1800s in order to gain insight about how the United States government and white settlers were affecting American Indian lives.

[“Does Where You Live Matter?”](#) **C3 IDM:** This annotated inquiry focuses on physical geography in general and on the relationship between early (pre-1700) Native American nations and their environments in particular through the compelling question “Does where you live matter?” The compelling question highlights the idea that geography is not a neutral entity. Environments can exert an influence on human existence, but they are not immune from change—human activity can modify the physical landscape. (While this inquiry focuses on New York, there were no state boundaries at that time, so it is still relevant for Vermont learners.)

[Florida Footprints: A Feral Land \(1704-1845\)](#) - **PBS Learning Media:** By the 18th and 19th centuries, Florida had been known to the Europeans for hundreds of years, but this area was far from tame. Spanish, French, British, American and Native Americans fight for control over “A Feral Land” once known as La Florida. Lesson includes video, maps, timelines and discussion questions.

[How Does a Map Show the Relationship Between People and the Environment?](#) - **iCivics Education:** In this lesson, students will think about how a map can show the relationship between people and the environment. The lesson begins with students learning new vocabulary to support the lesson. They will analyze a natural resource map of Maryland and list the vast resources available. Using historical maps and contemporary images, students will look for evidence of how

the growing population of the area has impacted the environment and make observations about the natural resources available over time.

Louisiana Purchase Debate - PBS Learning Media: Students read information and excerpts from primary sources about the Louisiana Purchase and create arguments “for” or “against” the purchase. Students engage in a debate about the Louisiana Purchase.

Manifest Destiny and the American Indians - PBS Learning Media: Students study the change in tribal lands over time. Students read about the Manifest Destiny of the 1800s and write a short opinion essay about the effects of Westward Expansion.

North America’s Great Waters: Explorers and Traders - PBS Learning Media: In this lesson, students will explore the expeditions of four French explorers. After viewing three short videos about Samuel de Champlain, Louis Jolliet and Jacques Marquette, and René-Robert Cavelier, Sieur de la Salle, students will analyze a painting that shows Champlain leading a fleet of canoes on an expedition and then read journal entries that describe Jolliet and Marquette’s expeditions. The lesson will conclude with students creating a game that encompasses the travels, settlements, and expansion of French territory in North America during the 1600s.

The New Nation - PBS Learning Media: Six lesson plans focused on Alexander Hamilton, Thomas Paine, and Benjamin Franklin; the lessons provide an overview and a procedure which includes vocabulary, additional resource materials, and necessary background for the educator.

The Vermont 250th in the Classroom - Vermont 250th Commission: This document provides varied lessons and resources to engage students in learning about the founding of the nation and the critical role that Vermont and Vermonters played in the War for Independence and the legacy they left on America; suggested grade levels have also been provided for elementary, middle, and high school students.

Westward Expansion, 1790-1850: Interactive Map - PBS Learning Media: Students can explore the territorial and population changes in the United States between 1790 and 1850 and consider the factors and resources that shaped and enabled westward expansion. After 1787, the newly established United States began to take an active part in the

exploration of North America. Cities grew up in land that was once frontier, gradually shifting the center of population westward. Support materials provided.

What Strategies Did Native Nations Use To Protect Their Sovereignty During the American Revolutionary War? -

iCivics Education: In this inquiry-based unit, students will become more familiar with Native history and people. They will learn about some elements of Native sovereignty and its importance in American history. Students will be reminded about the key ideas of the American Revolutionary War and learn a little bit about how the Americans talked about Native people in the Declaration of Independence. The unit ends with students learning about strategies the Native nations used to protect their land and sovereignty during the American Revolution.

History

Critical Proficiency (K-12): Students understand and evaluate change and continuity over time, recognize the multiplicity of points of view and make appropriate use of historical evidence in answering questions and developing arguments about the past.

Theme: Division

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Change, Continuity, and Context Create a chronological sequence to compare and contrast developments within a similar time period, with a focus on analyzing specific individuals or groups who shaped significant changes. (D2. His. 1, 3)	Students will be able to explain how individuals and groups have shaped the United States over time (e.g., from pre-colonial times through the Civil War).	Pre-Colonial and Early Colonial Era <i>Indigenous Leaders and Societies</i> • Iroquois Confederacy – A powerful alliance of Native tribes with a sophisticated political system that influenced democratic ideas in colonial America. • Pocahontas – Played a diplomatic role between the Powhatan Confederacy and English settlers in Virginia. <i>Explorers and Settlers</i> • John Smith – Early leader of Jamestown who helped stabilize the colony through strict discipline and negotiations with Native tribes. • Anne Hutchinson – Religious dissenter who challenged Puritan orthodoxy and promoted ideas of religious freedom and women's roles in society. Colonial Period and Revolutionary Era <i>Patriots and Founders</i> • Benjamin Franklin – Key figure in diplomacy, science, and political thought; helped secure French support during the American Revolution. • Phillis Wheatley – Enslaved African American poet whose writings challenged racial assumptions and supported the American cause.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Change, Continuity, and Context (continued)	(continued)	<i>Groups That Shaped Revolution</i> • Sons of Liberty – Organized protests and resistance against British taxation (e.g., Boston Tea Party). Daughters of Liberty – Supported the boycott of British goods and helped produce homemade goods to aid colonial self-reliance. Early Republic <i>Leaders and Thinkers</i> • Alexander Hamilton – Shaped the United States financial system and advocated for a strong federal government. • Thomas Jefferson – Principal author of the Declaration of Independence; expanded United States territory through the Louisiana Purchase. <i>African Americans and Abolitionists</i> • Richard Allen – Founded the African Methodist Episcopal Church and advocated for Black community leadership and education. Westward Expansion and Reform Movements <i>Pioneers and Settlers</i> • Lewis and Clark – Led the Corps of Discovery (1804–1806), mapping new territory and fostering United States expansion westward. • Sacagawea – Shoshone woman who guided and interpreted for Lewis and Clark, crucial to the expedition’s success.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Change, Continuity, and Context (continued)	(continued)	<i>Reformers and Movements</i> • Frederick Douglass – Former enslaved person who became a leading abolitionist, speaker, and writer advocating for freedom and equality. • Sojourner Truth – African American abolitionist and women's rights advocate who used powerful speeches to inspire action. • Temperance Movement – Led largely by women's groups, it sought to reduce alcohol consumption and address social issues tied to it. <i>Civil War Era</i> <i>Political Leaders</i> • Abraham Lincoln – 16th President who preserved the Union and issued the Emancipation Proclamation. • Stephen Douglas – Advocated for “popular sovereignty” regarding slavery; debated Lincoln in famous debates. <i>Military and Social Leaders</i> • Harriet Tubman – Former enslaved woman who led dozens to freedom via the Underground Railroad and later served as a spy for the Union. • Clara Barton – Pioneering nurse who founded the American Red Cross and transformed battlefield medicine during the Civil War.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Change, Continuity, and Context (continued)	(continued)	<i>Groups That Influenced Change</i> • Abolitionists – Groups like the American Anti-Slavery Society worked to end slavery through publications, speeches, and organizing. • Women’s Rights Activists – Figures like Elizabeth Cady Stanton and Lucretia Mott helped launch the women’s suffrage movement (Seneca Falls Convention, 1848).

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Perspectives Explain why individuals and groups during the same historical period had similar and /or different perspectives, and how those perspectives shaped the sources they influenced. (D2. His. 4-6)	Students will be able to explain that people had differing perspectives during the same historical period in the United States (e.g., during pre-colonial times or during Civil War). Students will be able to explain how people's perspectives shaped the historical sources they created. Students will be able to use simple historical events in the United States to explore how accounts can vary.	• Spread of Revolutionary ideas • Slavery and Abolitionist movement • Native American perspectives on land ownership; westward expansion • Settlers on religious freedom • Women's Rights advocates • States rights vs. federal power Pre-Colonial and Early Colonial Period Event: <i>European colonization and land settlement</i> • Native American perspective: Colonists were intruders disrupting long-held land, trade, and spiritual practices. • European settler perspective: They believed they were bringing "civilization," Christianity, and making productive use of land. American Revolution Event: <i>Declaration of Independence and the war for independence</i> • Patriot perspective: They fought for liberty and self-rule from British tyranny. • Loyalist perspective: Believed remaining loyal to the Crown was the best way to maintain order and protect property. • Enslaved African American perspective: Some saw British promises of freedom (e.g., Lord Dunmore's Proclamation) as a better chance for emancipation.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Perspectives (continued)	(continued)	Westward Expansion Event: <i>Louisiana Purchase and frontier settlement</i> • White settlers' perspective: Saw expansion as opportunity, freedom, and part of "Manifest Destiny." • Native American perspective: Saw it as encroachment, land loss, broken treaties, and violence. Trail of Tears (1830s) Event: <i>Forced relocation of Native American tribes</i> • United States government perspective: Believed relocation would reduce conflict and allow for American expansion. • Cherokee Nation perspective: Viewed it as unjust, brutal displacement from ancestral lands—despite legal attempts to stay. Civil War Era Event: <i>Slavery and sectional conflict</i> • Northern abolitionist perspective: Slavery was immoral and a violation of American ideals of liberty. • Southern slaveholder perspective: Slavery was essential to their economy and way of life; many claimed it was protected by the Constitution. • Enslaved person's perspective: Viewed slavery as brutal oppression and hoped for freedom through escape or Union victory.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Perspectives (continued)	(continued)	Women's Rights Movement (Antebellum Era) Event: <i>Seneca Falls Convention (1848)</i> • Women reformers' perspective: Believed women deserved equal rights, including suffrage and property rights. • Traditional male (and some female) perspective: Believed women's role was in the home and that equality would disrupt social norms.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Causation and Argumentation Explain probable causes and effects of events and developments. (D2, His. 14)	Students will be able to explain conflicts and compromises that led to the fight for independence from Great Britain. Students will be able to explain conflicts and compromises faced during the pre-Civil War period.	Conflicts Leading to the American Revolution French and Indian War (1754–1763) • Conflict: Britain and France (with Native allies) fought over land in North America. • Result: Britain won but incurred heavy debt, leading to new taxes on colonists. Proclamation of 1763 • Conflict: Banned colonial settlement west of the Appalachian Mountains to avoid Native conflict. • Colonial response: Colonists resented the restriction on land they felt entitled to after helping in the war. Stamp Act (1765) • Conflict: Required colonists to buy stamps for legal documents and newspapers. • Colonial reaction: "No taxation without representation!" — led to protests, boycotts, and the Stamp Act Congress. Boston Massacre (1770) • Conflict: British soldiers fired into a crowd of colonists, killing five. • Impact: Sparked outrage and used as propaganda by groups like the Sons of Liberty.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Causation and Argumentation (continued)	(continued)	Tea Act and Boston Tea Party (1773) • Conflict: Gave the British East India Company a monopoly on tea sales. • Colonial response: Colonists dumped tea into Boston Harbor in protest. Intolerable Acts (1774) • Conflict: Harsh laws passed to punish Massachusetts for the Tea Party (e.g., closed Boston Harbor). • Effect: United the colonies in opposition; led to the First Continental Congress. Battles of Lexington and Concord (1775) • Conflict: British troops tried to seize colonial weapons; first armed conflict of the revolution. • Effect: “The shot heard 'round the world” — beginning of armed resistance. Compromises (Attempts to Avoid War) Petition to the King (1774) • What: The First Continental Congress asked King George III to repeal the Intolerable Acts. • Result: Ignored by the King, which deepened colonial frustration.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Causation and Argumentation (continued)	(continued)	Olive Branch Petition (1775) • What: Final attempt by the Second Continental Congress to avoid war, pledging loyalty to the Crown but asking for peace. • Result: Rejected by King George III, who declared the colonies in open rebellion. Declaratory Act (1766) <i>(after repeal of Stamp Act)</i> • What: Parliament repealed the unpopular Stamp Act but declared it still had full authority to govern the colonies. • Result: Temporarily calmed tensions but reminded colonists that Britain still claimed power over them. Pre-Civil War Conflicts and Compromises Slavery in New Territories • Conflict: As the United States expanded west, debates erupted over whether new states should allow slavery. • Example: Bleeding Kansas (1854–1856) – Violent clashes between pro- and anti-slavery settlers after the Kansas-Nebraska Act allowed residents to vote on slavery.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Causation and Argumentation (continued)	(continued)	Abolitionist Movement vs. Slaveholders • Conflict: Growing abolitionist voices in the North (like Frederick Douglass, William Lloyd Garrison, Harriet Tubman) called for the end of slavery, while Southern leaders defended it as essential. • Example: Publication of Uncle Tom’s Cabin (1852) by Harriet Beecher Stowe stirred anti-slavery sentiment and angered the South. States’ Rights vs. Federal Power • Conflict: Southern states believed they had the right to govern themselves, especially on issues like slavery and tariffs, while the federal government increasingly intervened. • Example: Nullification Crisis (1832–1833) – South Carolina tried to nullify federal tariffs; President Jackson responded with threats of force. Dred Scott Decision (1857) • Conflict: Supreme Court ruled that African Americans could not be United States citizens and that Congress couldn’t ban slavery in the territories. Impact: Angered Northerners, delighted pro-slavery Southerners, and deepened sectional divides. Missouri Compromise (1820) • What: Missouri entered as a slave state, Maine as a free state; slavery banned in territories north of the 36°30’ line. • Goal: Maintain balance between free and slave states. • Result: Temporarily calmed tensions.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Causation and Argumentation (continued)	(continued)	Compromise of 1850 • What: • California admitted as a free state • Stricter Fugitive Slave Law • Popular sovereignty (states decide on slavery) in Utah and New Mexico • Result: Delayed conflict but increased Northern resistance, especially to returning escaped slaves. Kansas-Nebraska Act (1854) • What: Overturned Missouri Compromise by allowing popular sovereignty in Kansas and Nebraska. • Result: Led to Bleeding Kansas and greater North-South hostility

Resources

[A Sailor's Life for Me](#) - **USS Constitution Museum:** The War of 1812 is often referred to as our country's second war of independence. As a young nation, the United States' economy, territory, and rights of individual citizens were again threatened by the British. A Sailor's Life for Me! presents life at sea during the War of 1812 for those serving aboard USS Constitution, one of the few naval vessels in America's young navy, and now a national symbol, through interactive games, primary sources, and Museum resources.

[American Indians in a Changing World](#) -**The Gilder Lehrman Institute for American History:** Students will examine and analyze photographs of, poems by, and documents about American Indian experiences as European Americans migrated across the United States. They will use the knowledge gained through their analysis to write their own songs, poems, and letters.

Betrayal - **C3IDM**: This inquiry leads students through an investigation of leaders during the American Revolution. By investigating the compelling question ‘Is betrayal always bad?’ students evaluate the actions of King George III and George Washington. The formative performance tasks build on knowledge and skills through the course of the inquiry and help students understand the motives of patriots and loyalists.

Elementary Curriculum: Colonial America to Reconstruction - **The Gilder Lehrman Institute for American History**: This curated suite of resources for elementary school educators will help expand your knowledge of important topic areas in the elementary curriculum through a selection of six curated topics, such as Colonial America and the American Revolution. You will find lesson plans, student activity sheets, videos for students, interactive maps and timelines, recorded lectures, and free professional development courses.

Frederick Douglass: Orator, Editor, and Abolitionist - **PBS Learning Media**: Students explore what it means to speak out for your beliefs, or to right a wrong. After watching a short video, they will reflect on Douglass’s courage and the importance of literacy in his activism. They will read excerpts from Douglass’s autobiographies and examine an 1850 etching of Douglass being pulled away from a stage prior to giving a speech. Finally, they will reflect on Douglass’s importance as both a historical figure and as a role model for their own lives.

“Heroes of the American Revolution” - **C3 IDM** (5th grade inquiry that may require support): This inquiry leads students through an investigation of the American Revolution and the varying impacts of individuals who could be deemed heroes based on their impact. The compelling question, “What defines a hero?” allows students to consider all the actions of an individual and if they think that they are worthy of the title of hero.

“New France” - **C3 IDM** (5th grade inquiry that may require support): This inquiry focuses on the emergence, growth, and collapse of the New France colony in North America. French explorers, missionaries, traders, and settlers established an important presence in North America, beginning with Jacques Cartier’s explorations in 1534 and continuing through the 19th century. The development of the fur-trading industry, along with a relatively stable relationship with Native peoples in North America, peaked around 1710.

Pre- 1860 Disunion - **American Battlefield Trust**: This lesson allows students to look at pre-War cultures and economies of the Northern and Southern states and includes the actions of John Brown at Harper’s Ferry.

[The Mexican-American War](#) - **PBS Learning Media:** In this clip from *Latino Americans*, students will learn about the Mexican-American War. Until the mid 1800s, the region that is now the western United States was part of Mexico. Meanwhile, inspired by the notion of Manifest Destiny, United States leaders tried to buy and later went to war over this expanse of land. The result was that not only land, but people and long-standing settlements also became part of the United States.

[The New Nation](#) - **PBS Learning Media:** Six lesson plans focused on Alexander Hamilton, Thomas Paine, and Benjamin Franklin; the lessons provide an overview and a procedure which includes vocabulary, additional resource materials, and necessary background for the educator.

[Sojourner Truth: Abolitionist and Women's Rights Activist](#) - **PBS Learning Media:** In this lesson, students will learn about Sojourner Truth's egalitarian spirit in the face of institutional discrimination. After viewing a video about her life, students will examine an 1864 photograph of Truth and read excerpts of her most famous speech. The lesson concludes with students choosing a new name for a current-day exemplar of perseverance.

[Vermont History Kits](#) - **Vermont History Museum:** History Kits can be reserved from the Museum for a minimal fee, with topics such as "Abenaki in Vermont," "Vermont in the Civil War," and "Vermont in the Revolutionary War."